

Batch of four, select one

Every anchor in the account today is one generation — a skeleton, made so the boards could be laid out. None of them has been looked at. What follows is what to actually look at, by what kind of frame it is.

KIND OF FRAME	WHICH	WHAT DECIDES IT
Plate and location frames	F01, F02, F10, F23, F32	Judge at thumbnail size, squinting. You are checking key direction and where the bright shapes sit, not detail. Reject anything whose light disagrees with its plate.
Identity frames — a face at medium or closer	F06, F07, F35	Full size, and side by side with the character sheet. One moved feature is a rejection. Re-run on soul_2 with the Soul rather than arguing with a handle.
Shared frames	F02, F11, F12, F17, F30	Judged twice — once as the end of the shot before, once as the start of the shot after. A shared frame that only works one way is not chosen yet.
Match pairs	F09/F10, F22/F23	Only ever judged as a pair, laid side by side. Scale, colour and shape have to carry across the cut; either image alone tells you nothing.
Bridge frames	B01, B02	The test is whether they are dark or flat enough to hide a cut. If you can read detail in one, it is not a bridge.
Held shots — no cut permitted	S10, S13, S20	The composition has to survive being held for its whole duration. Look at it for the full sixteen seconds before choosing; boredom at second nine is a rejection.

Spend the allowance where the film is decided. F35 first — it is the last image in the film and it carries the whole ending. Then F06 and F07, the two-shot that has to hold fourteen seconds on one face. Then F17, the scale shot. Then the F09/F10 match, which is the only join between two movements. Everything else can be chosen in one pass.

Order of work

Gate A before any anchor is trusted: every reference on one screen, read left to right twice, looking for one thing — a face that moved. Then the anchors board by board. Then Gate B: all 39 on one contact sheet in film order. Drift caught at Gate B costs one image; the same drift caught after the motion pass costs a clip.